being able to chew and receive a wide variety of complementary foods.

Energy: Infants need energy from food for activity, growth, and normal development. Energy comes from foods containing carbohydrate, protein, or fat. A general indicator of infant consuming an adequate kilocalories per day is the infant's growth rate in length, weight, and head circumference.

Carbohydrate

The major type of carbohydrate normally consumed by young infants is lactose, the carbohydrate source in breast milk. Lactose-free infant formulas, such as soy-based infant formulas provide carbohydrates in the form of sucrose. In later infancy, infants derive carbohydrates from additional sources including cereal and other grain products, fruits, and vegetables.

Protein

Breast milk and infant formula contains protein. The complementary foods such as meat, poultry, fish, egg yolks, cheese, yogurt, pulses, cereals and other grain products provide adequate protein.

Fat

Breast milk and infant formula are important sources of lipids, including essential fatty acids, during infancy.

Vitamin A

Breast milk and infant formula are major food sources of vitamin A. Additional sources of vitamin A or carotenes for infants consuming complementary foods include egg yolks, yellow and dark green leafy vegetables and fruits e.g., spinach, greens, sweet potatoes and liver.

Vitamin E

Infants receive vitamin E from breast milk and infant formula. Other vitamin E sources for older infants include green leafy vegetables, vegetable oils and their products, wheat germ, whole-grain breads, cereals and other fortified or enriched grain products, butter, liver, and egg yolks.

Vitamin K

Sources of vitamin K include infant formula, green leafy vegetables, pork, and liver.

Vitamin C

Breast milk and infant formulas are major food sources of vitamin C. Additional vitamin C sources include vegetables (e.g., tomatoes), fruits (e.g., citrus fruits, papaya, and strawberries), and regular fruit and vegetable juices which are naturally high or fortified with vitamin C.

Vitamin B_{12}

An infant's vitamin B_{12} stores at birth generally supply his or her needs for approximately 8 months. Infants consuming appropriate amounts of breast milk from mothers with adequate B_{12} stores or infant formula receive adequate amounts of this vitamin. Complementary foods such as meat, egg yolks, and dairy products provide this vitamin later in infancy as well.

Calcium

An infant can obtain sufficient calcium by consuming adequate amounts of breast milk or infant formula. Older infants can obtain additional calcium from complementary foods such as yogurt, cheese, cottage cheese (paneer), fortified or enriched grain products, some green leafy vegetables (such as turnip and greens), and tofu.

Iron

Sources of iron for infants include breast milk, infant formula, meat, liver legumes, whole-grain breads, cereals, or fortified or enriched grain products, and dark

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